

🔮 React Native Master Guide — Level 7 (Complete Verbatim Edition)

Gestures & Micro-Animations: Reanimated 3 Engine, Worklets, Spring Physics, Pan Gestures & Swipe-to-Dismiss

EXPO V54 • NATIVEWIND / TAILWIND CSS • ES6+

⚡ Level 7.1 & 7.2: The UI Thread vs. JS Thread & Reanimated 3 Core Primitives

1. Mental Model: Why Legacy Animated Stutters vs. Reanimated 3 🤖

In React Native, your app runs on **two separate execution threads**:



What is a "Worklet"?

A **Worklet** is a tiny JavaScript function that gets compiled and executed **directly inside the Native UI Thread**. Even if your JavaScript thread is frozen parsing a 10 MB JSON payload, **your Reanimated animations will glide at 120 FPS without a single frame drop!** 🤖💡

2. The 4 Essential Reanimated 3 Primitives

Primitive	What it does	Mental Model
<code>useSharedValue(initial)</code>	Stores a mutable variable directly in UI Thread memory.	Like <code>useRef</code> , but UI thread reads it instantly without re-rendering the JS component.
<code>useAnimatedStyle(() => {})</code>	Maps shared values to dynamic styles (transform, opacity, scale).	Runs as a worklet on the UI thread whenever the shared value changes.
<code>withTiming(toValue, config)</code>	Animates a value linearly or with easing curves over a fixed duration (e.g., 300ms).	Best for color transitions, opacities, and progress bars.
<code>withSpring(toValue, config)</code>	Animates a value using real-world physics (mass, damping, stiffness).	Best for natural bounces, button presses, swipe cards, and toggles!

3. Easing (withTiming) vs. Physics (withSpring)



Code Example: Interactive Spring Micro-Interactions & Pulsing Radar

```
import React, { useState } from 'react';
import { View, Text, Pressable } from 'react-native';
import { SafeAreaView, SafeAreaView } from 'react-native-safe-area-context';
import { StatusBar } from 'expo-status-bar';

// =====
// 🚀 1. SIMULATED REANIMATED SPRING ENGINE
// (Demonstrating UI Thread Shared Value & Spring Mechanics)
// =====
const App = () => {
  // State 1: Interactive Physics Button Scale (Spring)
  const [buttonPressed, setButtonPressed] = useState(false);

  // State 2: Smooth Toggle Switch (0 = Left, 1 = Right)
  const [toggleActive, setToggleActive] = useState(false);

  // State 3: Card Expand / Collapse
  const [isExpanded, setIsExpanded] = useState(false);

  return (
    <SafeAreaView>
      <StatusBar style="light" backgroundColor="#090d16" />
      <SafeAreaView className="flex-1 bg-slate-950 px-5 pt-3 justify-between pb-6">

        <View className="flex-1">
          { /* Header */ }
          <View className="mb-6">
            <Text className="text-2xl font-black text-sky-400">Reanimated 3 🚀</Text>
            <Text className="text-slate-400 text-xs">
              UI-Thread Micro-Animations & Spring Physics (120 FPS)
            </Text>
          </View>

          { /* 🌟 1. SPRING PHYSICS BOUNCY BUTTON */ }
          <View className="bg-slate-900 border border-slate-800 p-5 rounded-3xl mb-4 shadow-xl">
            <Text className="text-white font-bold text-sm mb-1">
              1. Physics Button Press (`withSpring`)
            </Text>
            <Text className="text-slate-400 text-xs mb-4">
              Scales down on press and bounces back naturally using spring damping.
            </Text>

            <Pressable
              onPressIn={() => setButtonPressed(true)}
              onPressOut={() => setButtonPressed(false)}
              className={`p-4 rounded-2xl items-center transition-all ${
                buttonPressed
                  ? 'bg-sky-600 scale-95 shadow-sm'
                  : 'bg-sky-500 scale-100 shadow-lg'
              }`}
            >
              <Text className="text-white font-black text-base">
                {buttonPressed ? 'Compacted 📦' : 'Press to Bounce 🚀'}
              </Text>
            </Pressable>
          </View>

          { /* 🎛️ 2. NATIVE TOGGLE SWITCH */ }
          <View className="bg-slate-900 border border-slate-800 p-5 rounded-3xl mb-4 flex-row justify-between items-center shadow">
            <View className="flex-1 pr-4">
              <Text className="text-white font-bold text-sm">2. Spring Toggle Switch</Text>
              <Text className="text-slate-400 text-xs mt-0.5">
                Translates knob on the UI thread with spring physics
              </Text>
            </View>

            <Pressable
              onPress={() => setToggleActive((prev) => !prev)}
              className={`w-16 h-9 rounded-full p-1 transition-colors ${
                toggleActive ? 'bg-emerald-500' : 'bg-slate-800'
              }`}
            >
            </Pressable>
          </View>
        </SafeAreaView>
      </SafeAreaView>
    )
  );
}
```

```

    </View>
    <View
      className={`w-7 h-7 rounded-full bg-white shadow-md transition-transform ${
        toggleActive ? 'translate-x-7' : 'translate-x-0'
      }`}
    />
  </Pressable>
</View>

{/* 🧭 3. ACCORDION EXPAND / COLLAPSE */}
<View className="bg-slate-900 border border-slate-800 p-5 rounded-3xl shadow-xl">
  <Pressable
    onPress={() => setIsExpanded((prev) => !prev)}
    className="flex-row justify-between items-center"
  >
    <View>
      <Text className="text-white font-bold text-sm">3. Accordion Transition</Text>
      <Text className="text-slate-400 text-xs mt-0.5">
        Tap to trigger layout height animation
      </Text>
    </View>
    <Text className="text-sky-400 font-extrabold text-base">
      {isExpanded ? '▲ Hide' : '▼ Expand'}
    </Text>
  </Pressable>

  {isExpanded && (
    <View className="mt-4 pt-4 border-t border-slate-800/80 gap-2">
      <Text className="text-slate-300 text-xs leading-relaxed">
        ⚡ <strong>useSharedValue:</strong> Stores variables in UI Thread memory.
      </Text>
      <Text className="text-slate-300 text-xs leading-relaxed">
        🧑‍🔧 <strong>useAnimatedStyle:</strong> Runs as a worklet without triggering JS component re-renders.
      </Text>
      <Text className="text-slate-300 text-xs leading-relaxed">
        🏎️ <strong>60-120 FPS:</strong> Zero bridge overhead ensures buttery smooth performance.
      </Text>
    </View>
  )}
</View>

</View>

{/* Radar Live Status Indicator */}
<View className="bg-slate-900 border border-slate-800 p-4 rounded-2xl flex-row items-center justify-between">
  <View className="flex-row items-center gap-2.5">
    <View className="w-3 h-3 rounded-full bg-emerald-400 animate-pulse" />
    <Text className="text-slate-300 text-xs font-semibold">
      UI Thread Worklet Engine Active
    </Text>
  </View>
  <Text className="text-emerald-400 font-black text-xs">120 FPS ⚡</Text>
</View>

</SafeAreaView>
</SafeAreaProvider>
);
};

export default App;

```

🧑‍🔧 Telugu + English Explanation:

- **JS Thread vs UI Thread:** Normal React Native lo JavaScript thread API calls & calculations tho busy ga unte animations lag avthayi. Kani **Reanimated 3** lo animations direct ga phone **Native UI Thread** meeda run avthayi. JS thread hang ayina kooda animations super smooth ga 60 to 120 FPS speed tho glide avthayi!
- **useSharedValue:** Idi component state ([useState](#)) lanti normal variable kadu. Idi UI thread memory lo store ayye dynamic value. Idi change ayinappudu component motham re-render avvadu, visual animated style mathrame update avthundi.
- **withSpring:** Physics math tho pani chesthundi (bouncy ball bounce ayinattu). Natural button presses and swipe gestures ki idi best!

👉 Level 7.3 & 7.4: Pan Gestures, Interpolation & Swipe-to-Dismiss

1. Mental Model: The Gesture Lifecycle on the UI Thread

`react-native-gesture-handler` provides direct native-level touch recognition. We chain methods to create a gesture:

```
const panGesture = Gesture.Pan()  
  // 1. When finger touches the screen  
  .onBegin(() => {  
    console.log('Touch started');  
  })  
  // 2. As finger moves (runs 120 times/sec on the UI thread)  
  .onUpdate((event) => {  
    translateX.value = event.translationX;  
  })  
  // 3. When finger lifts off the screen  
  .onEnd((event) => {  
    if (Math.abs(translateX.value) > SWIPE_THRESHOLD) {  
      // Swiped far enough -> Dismiss off-screen!  
      translateX.value = withTiming(500);  
    } else {  
      // Not far enough -> Snap back to center with spring!  
      translateX.value = withSpring(0);  
    }  
  })  
);
```

2. Mental Model: What is Interpolation?

Interpolation maps an input range (like how many pixels you dragged a card) into an output range (like opacity, rotation, or scale):

Drag Distance (translateX) :	[-200px ——— 0px ——— +200px]
Mapped Opacity (opacity) :	[0.0 ——— 1.0 ——— 0.0]
Mapped Rotation (deg) :	[-15deg ——— 0deg ——— +15deg]

```
const animatedCardStyle = useAnimatedStyle(() => {  
  const opacity = interpolate(  
    translateX.value,  
    [-150, 0, 150], // Input: Dragging Left or right  
    [0.3, 1, 0.3], // Output: Fades out as you drag away  
    Extrapolation.CLAMP  
  );  
  
  const rotate = `${interpolate(translateX.value, [-200, 200], [-12, 12])}deg`;  
  
  return {  
    transform: [{ translateX: translateX.value }, { rotate }],  
    opacity,  
  };  
});
```

Code Example: Interactive Swipe-to-Dismiss Task Card System

```
import React, { useState } from 'react';
import { View, Text, Pressable, FlatList } from 'react-native';
import { SafeAreaView, SafeAreaView } from 'react-native-safe-area-context';
import { StatusBar } from 'expo-status-bar';

const INITIAL_TASKS = [
  { id: '1', title: 'Review Reanimated 3 Worklets PR', priority: 'High', color: 'border-red-500/40 bg-red-500/10 text-red-400' },
  { id: '2', title: 'Configure MMKV Offline Storage', priority: 'Medium', color: 'border-amber-500/40 bg-amber-500/10 text-amb' },
  { id: '3', title: 'Test Native Stack Transitions on iOS', priority: 'Low', color: 'border-sky-500/40 bg-sky-500/10 text-sky-' },
  { id: '4', title: 'Optimize FlatList Recycling Window', priority: 'High', color: 'border-red-500/40 bg-red-500/10 text-red-4' },
];

const App = () => {
  const [tasks, setTasks] = useState(INITIAL_TASKS);
  const [swipedItem, setSwipedItem] = useState(null);

  // Swipe Action Handler
  const handleDeleteTask = (id) => {
    setSwipedItem(id);
    setTimeout(() => {
      setTasks((prev) => prev.filter((t) => t.id !== id));
      setSwipedItem(null);
    }, 250);
  };

  const handleReset = () => {
    setTasks(INITIAL_TASKS);
  };

  return (
    <SafeAreaView>
      <StatusBar style="light" backgroundColor="#090d16" />
      <SafeAreaView className="flex-1 bg-slate-950 px-5 pt-3 justify-between pb-6">

        <View className="flex-1">
          { /* Header */ }
          <View className="flex-row justify-between items-center mb-4">
            <View>
              <Text className="text-2xl font-black text-sky-400">Swipe Gestures 🤞</Text>
              <Text className="text-slate-400 text-xs">Pan Gestures, Interpolation & Spring Snap</Text>
            </View>

            {tasks.length < INITIAL_TASKS.length && (
              <Pressable
                onPress={handleReset}
                className="bg-slate-900 border border-slate-800 px-3.5 py-2 rounded-xl"
              >
                <Text className="text-sky-400 font-bold text-xs">Reset All 🔄</Text>
              </Pressable>
            )}
          </View>

          { /* Instructions Banner */ }
          <View className="bg-slate-900 border border-slate-800 p-4 rounded-2xl mb-5 flex-row items-center gap-3">
            <Text className="text-2xl">👉</Text>
            <Text className="text-slate-300 text-xs flex-1 leading-relaxed">
              <strong>Swipe any card:</strong> Drag right or left to reveal the delete action. Spring physics automatically sr
            </Text>
          </View>

          { /* Task List */ }
          {tasks.length === 0 ? (
            <View className="flex-1 justify-center items-center py-16">
              <Text className="text-4xl mb-3">🧹</Text>
              <Text className="text-white font-bold text-base">All Tasks Cleared</Text>
              <Text className="text-slate-400 text-xs mt-1 mb-4">You have swiped away all items.</Text>
              <Pressable
                onPress={handleReset}
                className="bg-sky-500 px-5 py-2.5 rounded-xl"
              >
                <Text className="text-white font-bold text-xs">Reload Tasks</Text>
              </Pressable>
            </View>
          ) : (
            <FlatList
              data={tasks}
              renderItem={() => {
                const task = tasks.find((t) => t.id === swipedItem);
                if (task) {
                  handleDeleteTask(task.id);
                }
              }}
              keyExtractor={item => item.id}
            />
          )}
        </SafeAreaView>
      </SafeAreaView>
    )
  );
};
```

```

        </Pressable>
      </View>
    ) : (
      <FlatList
        data={tasks}
        keyExtractor={({item}) => item.id}
        ItemSeparatorComponent={() => <View className="h-3" />}
        renderItem={({ item }) => {
          const isDismissing = swipedItem === item.id;

          return (
            <View className="relative rounded-2xl overflow-hidden">
              {/* Background Delete Action Layer */}
              <View className="absolute inset-0 bg-red-600 rounded-2xl flex-row justify-between items-center px-6">
                <Text className="text-white font-black text-xs">🗑️ DELETE</Text>
                <Text className="text-white font-black text-xs">DELETE 🗑️</Text>
              </View>

              {/* Foreground Draggable Card */}
              <View
                className={`bg-slate-900 border border-slate-800 p-4 rounded-2xl justify-between transition-all ${
                  isDismissing ? 'translate-x-full opacity-0' : 'translate-x-0 opacity-100'
                }`}
              >
                <View className="flex-row justify-between items-start mb-2">
                  <Text className="text-white font-bold text-sm flex-1 pr-3">
                    {item.title}
                  </Text>
                  <View className={`px-2.5 py-0.5 rounded-full border ${item.color}`}>
                    <Text className="text-[10px] font-extrabold uppercase">
                      {item.priority}
                    </Text>
                  </View>
                </View>

                <View className="flex-row justify-between items-center mt-2 border-t border-slate-800/80 pt-2.5">
                  <Text className="text-slate-500 text-[11px] font-mono">
                    ID: #{item.id} • Gesture.Pan()
                  </Text>

                  <Pressable
                    onPress={() => handleDeleteTask(item.id)}
                    className="bg-slate-800 active:bg-red-500/20 px-3 py-1.5 rounded-lg border border-slate-700"
                  >
                    <Text className="text-red-400 font-bold text-xs">Swipe Away →</Text>
                  </Pressable>
                </View>
              </View>
            </View>
          );
        }}
      />
    )}

  </View>

  {/* Gesture Physics Status Pill */}
  <View className="bg-slate-900 border border-slate-800 p-3.5 rounded-2xl flex-row items-center justify-between">
    <View className="flex-row items-center gap-2">
      <View className="w-2.5 h-2.5 rounded-full bg-sky-400 animate-pulse" />
      <Text className="text-slate-300 text-xs font-semibold">
        Native Gesture Recognizer
      </Text>
    </View>
    <Text className="text-sky-400 font-mono text-xs">Active 🎮</Text>
  </View>

</SafeAreaView>
</SafeAreaProvider>
);
};

```

```
export default App;
```

🧠 Telugu + English Explanation:

- **Gesture.Pan()**: Mobile screen meeda user finger ni drag chesthunappudu, finger coordinate changes (`event.translationX`, `event.translationY`) ni calculate chesthundi.
- **Threshold & Spring Snap-back**: User card ni 40% kante ekkuva dooram swipe chesthe card screen nundi dismiss aypothundi (`withTiming`). Kani madhyaloney vadilithe, `withSpring(0)` valla card direct ga initial center position loki bounce ayyi snap-back avthundi!
- **Interpolation**: Card ni drag chesthunna distance (`translateX`) batti, card ఓపకీ opacity thaggadam and card slight ga tilt (rotate) avvadam lanti effects create cheyadaniki `interpolate()` use chestham.